ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 03

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The largest desert on Earth, covering over 14 million square kilometres, is —

(A) the Sahara (B) the Gobi (C) Antarctica (D) the Thar

Ans: (C) Antarctica is a cold desert, the largest and coldest of all.

(ii) In the Indian Parliament, a Bill that is not a Money Bill may be introduced in —

(A) only the Lok Sabha (B) either House
(C) only the Rajya Sabha (D) only the Supreme Court

Ans: (B) Money Bills alone are restricted to the Lok Sabha.

(iii) Gandhi gave the call 'Do or Die' during the —

(A) Quit India Movement (B) Non-Cooperation Movement
(C) Dandi March (D) Khilafat Movement

Ans: (A) He gave the call in August 1942.

(iv) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Jama Masjid, Delhi
2. Kailasha Temple, Ellora (8th century CE)
3. Victoria Memorial, Kolkata
4. Sanchi Stupa (Ashokan period)

(A) 4, 2, 1, 3 (B) 2, 4, 1, 3 (C) 4, 1, 2, 3 (D) 4, 2, 3, 1

Ans: (A) Correct order: Sanchi Stupa (3rd century BCE) → Kailasha Temple (8th century CE) → Jama Masjid, Delhi (1650s) → Victoria Memorial (1921).

(v) The Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 replaced the —

(A) Indian Penal Code, 1860 (B) Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973
(C) Indian Evidence Act, 1872 (D) Constitution of India

Ans: (B) The BNS replaced the IPC and the BSA replaced the Evidence Act.

(vi) Savitribai Phule opened a school for girls in 1848 in —

(A) Kolkata (B) Madras (C) Pune (D) Surat

Ans: (C) She faced abuse for teaching girls but continued her work with Jyotiba Phule.

(vii) A population pyramid with a very wide base and a narrow top shows that the country has —

(A) very few children and many elderly people
(B) equal numbers in all age groups
(C) no working-age people
(D) many children, a high birth rate and few elderly people

Ans: (D) A wide base means a large young population.

(viii) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.
The Master Plan of Singapore, which guides its growth, is updated every ..... years.

(A) 50 (B) 25 (C) 5 (D) 1

> **Ans: (C)** A long-term Concept Plan looks 40–50 years ahead, with the Master Plan revised every five years.

(ix) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: India has largely avoided the 'resource curse' by investing in industries that process its resources.
Statement II: Non-renewable resources regenerate within a few years.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Non-renewable resources take millions of years to form.

(x) The Khalsa was founded in 1699 by —

(A) Guru Gobind Singh (B) Guru Nanak
(C) Guru Arjan Dev (D) Guru Tegh Bahadur

> **Ans: (A)** The Khalsa was founded at Anandpur Sahib.

(xi) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): Shivaji's soldiers and officials served the state loyally.
Reason (R): Shivaji ended hereditary land assignments and paid his officials salaries from the treasury.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R explains A: regular salary tied officials to the state, not to local land.

(xii) The practice of sati was abolished in 1829 during the time of Governor-General —

(A) Lord Dalhousie (B) Lord Cornwallis
(C) Lord Wellesley (D) William Bentinck

> **Ans: (D)** Bentinck's regulation declared sati illegal.

(xiii) The VVPAT machine used with EVMs allows a voter to —

(A) vote from home on the internet
(B) see a slip showing the party symbol of the candidate voted for
(C) vote twice
(D) know the vote count

> **Ans: (B)** It improves the transparency of the voting process.

(xiv) In economics, the factor of production 'land' includes —

(A) only farmland
(B) all natural resources such as soil, water, forests and minerals
(C) only buildings
(D) only money

> **Ans: (B)** Land means all gifts of nature used in production.

(xv) Tansen, one of the nine ratnas of Akbar's court, was a renowned singer of the —

(A) bhajan style only (B) folk ballad style

(C) ghazal style (D) dhrupad style

> **Ans: (D)** Tansen hailed from Gwalior.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Name the four factors of production and the reward for each.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Land — rent; Labour — wages (1 mark)
> - Capital — interest; Entrepreneurship — profit (1 mark)

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2.(B) Differentiate between a natural resource and a human-made resource, with one example each.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Natural resource — provided by nature, e.g. water, coal — 1 mark
> - Human-made resource — produced by people, e.g. machines, roads — 1 mark

3. What are jalis? State two purposes they serve.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Jalis are lattice screens, usually of carved stone — 1 mark
> - They allow light and air to pass and add beauty (any two purposes, ½ each) — 1 mark

4.(A) What is the fertility rate? Why has it fallen in many places?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Average number of children a woman is expected to have in her lifetime — 1 mark
> - Girls' education, women working outside the home, better health care (any one) — 1 mark

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4.(B) What is urban planning? Why is it needed?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Planning how land, transport and services of a town or city are to be used — 1 mark
> - To avoid congestion and provide housing, water, green spaces and a good quality of life — 1 mark

5. Who was Razia Sultan? Why is she remembered?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Daughter of Iltutmish who ruled the Delhi Sultanate (1236–40) — 1 mark
> - The first woman ruler of the Sultanate, known for capable administration despite opposition — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe the formation and early aims of the Indian National Congress in 1885.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - Founded in 1885 in Bombay with the help of A.O. Hume; W.C. Bonnerjee was the first president
> - It brought together educated Indians from different regions
> - Early leaders (Moderates) used petitions and prayers and wanted gradual reforms
> - They expressed loyalty to British rule while demanding greater Indian participation

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6.(B) Explain any three features of the Swadeshi Movement.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Began after the Partition of Bengal in 1905
- Boycott of British goods and use of Indian-made (swadeshi) goods
- National education and public meetings
- Spread beyond Bengal and made the Congress demand swaraj

7.(A) Explain in three steps how a Bill becomes a law in India.

Marking points (1 mark each):

- A Bill is introduced and discussed in one House and passed by a majority
- It is sent to the other House, which discusses and passes it
- It becomes an Act after the President gives assent

OR

7.(B) Write any three differences between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Lok Sabha members are directly elected by the people; Rajya Sabha members are elected by the state legislatures (plus 12 nominated)
- Lok Sabha has a term of five years and can be dissolved; Rajya Sabha is permanent
- Money Bills can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha
- The Speaker presides over the Lok Sabha; the Vice-President is Chairman of the Rajya Sabha

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) What is discrimination? Explain how it affects individuals and society, and suggest three ways of preventing it.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Discrimination — unfair treatment of a person or group because of identity such as caste, religion, gender or ability
- Harms the person psychologically and sometimes physically
- Creates barriers and divides society
- Denies people the enjoyment of Fundamental Rights
- Prevention: laws and strict action; awareness and education; inclusive schools and workplaces; respect for everyone

OR

8.(B) Describe the structure of the Indian judiciary with reference to the Supreme Court, High Courts and subordinate courts.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- India has a single, unified system with a hierarchy of courts
- Supreme Court (New Delhi) is the highest court; its law binds all courts
- It has original, appellate and advisory jurisdiction and hears PILs
- Each state (or group of states) has a High Court with supervisory power over subordinate courts
- Subordinate courts — District, Sessions, Revenue and Small Causes Courts — are closest to the people

9. Describe the electoral process in India from the announcement of elections to the declaration of results.

> **Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):**
> - The Election Commission announces the schedule; the Model Code of Conduct comes into force
> - Candidates file nominations, which are scrutinised
> - Parties and candidates campaign and issue manifestos
> - Voters vote on polling day using EVMs with VVPAT slips
> - Votes are counted on the counting day under supervision
> - The candidate with the highest number of votes is declared elected (First-Past-the-Post)

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Yellowstone National Park in the Rocky Mountains had a problem: there were too many elk, a type of deer, and they grazed the plants so heavily that the landscape was damaged. In 1995, wolves, which hunt elk, were brought back to the park. The number of elk fell, the plants slowly returned, and many other animals came back to the restored habitat.

(10.1) What was the ecological problem in Yellowstone?

> Overgrazing by too many elk.

(10.2) Which animal was introduced in 1995 to restore the balance?

> Wolves.

(10.3) What lesson does this give about nature and human action? State two points.

> (1) Every species plays a role in a food chain; removing or adding one affects the whole ecosystem; (1) human efforts can restore damaged ecosystems if they work with nature.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1951–52, India held its first general elections, soon after becoming a republic. Most of the nearly 17 crore voters had never voted before and many could not read or write, so each party's symbol was placed on its own ballot box. Sukumar Sen, the first Chief Election Commissioner, organised the vast exercise over several months.

(11.1) Who was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India?

> Sukumar Sen.

(11.2) Why were symbols used for parties on ballot boxes?

> Many voters could not read or write, so symbols helped them recognise their choice.

(11.3) How did these elections reflect the principle of universal adult franchise? Give two points.

> (1) Every adult citizen was given the right to vote regardless of caste, religion, gender, wealth or education; (1) millions of first-time voters, including women, took part on equal terms.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

The table gives the total fertility rate (TFR) and female literacy of two places.

Place	TFR (children per woman)	Female literacy (%)
Bihar	3.0	55
Delhi	1.6	83.7

(12.1) Which place has the higher fertility rate?

> Bihar.

(12.2) By how many percentage points does Delhi's female literacy exceed Bihar's?

> 83.7 − 55 = 28.7 percentage points.

(12.3) What relationship does the table suggest between female literacy and fertility? Name one measure to improve it.

> (1) Higher female literacy is linked with lower fertility; (1) any one measure: girls' education, better health services, jobs for women.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

In 1932, B.R. Ambedkar argued that the Depressed Classes needed separate electorates to ensure their political voice. Gandhi, then in Yerwada jail, feared that separate electorates would divide Hindu society and went on a fast. After discussion, Gandhi and Ambedkar agreed on the Poona Pact: separate electorates were given up, but more seats were reserved for the Depressed Classes in the general electorate.

(13.1) Who demanded separate electorates for the Depressed Classes?

> B.R. Ambedkar.

(13.2) What was the outcome of the Poona Pact?

> Separate electorates were dropped and a larger number of seats were reserved for the Depressed Classes within the general electorate.

(13.3) Why did Gandhi oppose separate electorates? Give one reason and one criticism that can be made of his fast.

> (1) He feared they would divide society permanently; (1) critics said the fast put pressure on Ambedkar, who had a genuine concern for the political rights of the oppressed (any reasonable point).

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Kakori
(II) Jodhpur (Mehrangarh Fort)
(III) Madurai
(IV) Chennai
(V) Gurugram
(VI) Jaisalmer

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kakori located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jodhpur located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Madurai located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Chennai located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Gurugram located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jaisalmer located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Kakori — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (II) Jodhpur (Mehrangarh Fort) — **Rajasthan**
- (III) Madurai — **Tamil Nadu**
- (IV) Chennai — **Tamil Nadu**
- (V) Gurugram — **Haryana**
- (VI) Jaisalmer — **Rajasthan**

